

Diphenhydramine

(Benadryl, Unisom, Sominex, Nytol)

- I. **Classification** – Antihistamine, Anticholinergic
- II. **Action(s)**
 - Antagonizes central and peripheral H1-Receptors (Non-selective)
 - Antagonizes cholinergic pathways
 - Suppresses medullary cough center
- III. **Indication(s)**
 - Allergic reactions (Moderate – Severe)
 - Dystonic reactions
 - Non-EMS uses include: Insomnia, Motion Sickness
- IV. **Contraindications**
 - Known hypersensitivity
 - Recent potassium administration
- V. **Precautions**
 - Elderly and children < 6 years old
 - Cardiovascular disease
 - COPD / Asthma
 - Angle-closure glaucoma
 - May induce significant change in mental status
- VI. **Drug interactions**
 - Potassium – May cause gastric ulceration with recent Potassium ingestion
 - Haloperidol – Q-T prolongation, cardiac dysrhythmias, severe anticholinergic effect
 - MAO Inhibitors – May increase anticholinergic effects
 - Pain medications – May increase CNS depression
- VII. **Adult Dosing and Administration**
 - 25-50mg IV/ IM / PO slowly (do not exceed 25 mg/min)
- VIII. **Pediatric Dosing and Administration**
 - 1 mg/kg IV/ IM / PO slowly (do not exceed 25 mg/min) (Max dose 50 mg)
- IX. **Onset**
 - 5-10 minutes
- X. **Duration**
 - 4-10 hours
- VIII. **Possible Adverse Effects**
 - Anaphylaxis, Seizures, drowsiness, dizziness, disturbance in coordination
 - Arrhythmias, tachycardia, bradycardia, palpitations
 - Dry mouth, headache
- IX. **Other Notes**
 - Increases sedative potential of all medications
 - Found in many OTC medications for adults and children